



## HOW TO PLAY

### *autumn memories*

# Start Here: Leading Fall Activities

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## Who this is for

Caregivers, activity directors, and families looking for warm, seasonal activities to share with an older adult this autumn. Every activity is low prep, needs only the printout and a kind voice, and works one on one or with a small group.

## How to lead it

Read slowly and give plenty of time to answer. In the conversation activities there are no wrong answers, only stories worth hearing. For the quizzes, offer gentle hints and celebrate every try. Keep each session to twenty or thirty minutes and let the pace stay easy.

## A gentle note

Follow the person's lead. If a memory of an autumn long ago brings joy, linger there. The goal is connection and a good moment together on a crisp fall day, not a perfect score.





## CONVERSATION

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# Remember When: Autumns Gone By

Read one prompt at a time and give the person plenty of room to answer. Follow the story wherever it leads. These are meant to open doors to warm autumn memories, not to test recall.

- ☐ What did the first cool day of fall feel like when you were young
- ☐ Tell me about walking to school on an autumn morning
- ☐ Did you ever jump in a big pile of raked leaves
- ☐ What did your family do when the weather turned cold
- ☐ What was your favorite thing about going back to school in the fall
- ☐ Did you help bring in a harvest or tend a garden in autumn
- ☐ What warm clothes came out of the closet when fall arrived
- ☐ Tell me about a bonfire or a fire in the fireplace you remember
- ☐ What did the trees look like where you grew up in autumn
- ☐ Did your family can, pickle, or put up food for the winter
- ☐ What was a chore you did outside before the cold set in
- ☐ Tell me about a fall fair, festival, or church supper you loved
- ☐ What did the kitchen smell like on a cool autumn day
- ☐ Did you ever go apple picking or visit an orchard
- ☐ What games did children play once it was too cold to swim
- ☐ What did you wear to keep warm walking home in November
- ☐ Tell me about a Thanksgiving from when you were young
- ☐ Who did the cooking when the family gathered in the fall
- ☐ What is a sound that reminds you of autumn
- ☐ What is your happiest memory of a fall long ago





## QUIZ

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# Finish the Familiar Fall Saying

Read the first half of each well known saying out loud and let the group call out the ending. Say it together and share what the saying means to you. Answers are on the leader key.

1. Make hay while the sun...

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2. You reap what you...

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3. Turn over a new...

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4. The apple never falls far from the...

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5. Save it for a rainy...

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6. When one door closes, another one...

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7. Do not put all your eggs in one...

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8. A bird in the hand is worth two in the...

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9. April showers bring May...

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10. One bad apple spoils the...

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11. Waste not, want...

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12. Many hands make light...

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13. As snug as a bug in a...

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14. The bigger they are, the harder they...

.....





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# Finish the Familiar Fall Saying: Leader Answer Key

## Answers 1 to 7

1. Shines. 2. Sow. 3. Leaf. 4. Tree. 5. Day. 6. Opens. 7. Basket.

## Answers 8 to 14

8. Bush. 9. Flowers. 10. Bunch, or barrel. 11. Not. 12. Work. 13. Rug. 14. Fall.  
Accept any warm answer that fits.





## CONVERSATION

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# Remember When: Harvest, Kitchen, and Cozy Days

Continue the conversation with these prompts about the comforts of the season. Let the person take the lead and enjoy the memories together.

- ☐ What was the best thing to eat on a cold autumn evening
- ☐ Tell me about a soup or stew that warmed the house
- ☐ Did your mother or grandmother bake pies in the fall
- ☐ What did a Sunday dinner look like when the weather turned
- ☐ What did you drink to keep warm on a chilly day
- ☐ Tell me about putting up preserves, jam, or pickles
- ☐ What was a comfort food only made in the cooler months
- ☐ Did you have a garden, and what did you gather in the fall
- ☐ What blanket, quilt, or sweater kept you warm
- ☐ Tell me about a kitchen you loved being in
- ☐ What did the family do together on a rainy fall night
- ☐ What was the first thing you cooked when it got cold
- ☐ Did you gather nuts, apples, or pumpkins in the fall
- ☐ What smell coming from the oven made your mouth water
- ☐ Tell me about a harvest or a good crop you remember
- ☐ What did you and the neighbors share from the garden
- ☐ What was your favorite pie of all
- ☐ Did you ever help make cider, applesauce, or preserves
- ☐ What made a house feel cozy when you were young
- ☐ What is a recipe you hope your family keeps making





## QUIZ

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# Autumn and Harvest Trivia

Read each question out loud and let the group answer together. Offer hints and celebrate every good guess. This is for smiles and conversation, so accept any close answer. The leader key follows.

1. What do we call the season between summer and winter, known for falling leaves?

2. What round orange fruit is carved into a jack o lantern?

3. Which holiday in November is famous for a big turkey dinner?

4. What fruit is picked in orchards in the fall and made into pies and cider?

5. What do we call the time when farmers gather in their crops?

6. What warm drink is made from pressed apples?

7. What do squirrels gather and bury to store for the winter?

8. What piece of clothing do we reach for on the first cool day?

9. In what month does fall usually begin in the United States?

10. What colorful change happens to the leaves on the trees each fall?

11. What figure with a straw hat stands in a field to scare off birds?

12. What outdoor chore uses a rake and makes a big pile?

13. What tall plant with a golden tassel is harvested in the fall?

14. What orange vegetable, good for your eyes, is a fall favorite besides pumpkin?







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# Autumn and Harvest Trivia: Leader Answer Key



## Answers 1 to 7

1. Autumn, or fall. 2. A pumpkin. 3. Thanksgiving. 4. Apples. 5. The harvest.  
6. Apple cider. 7. Acorns or nuts.

## Answers 8 to 14

8. A sweater, jacket, or coat. 9. September. 10. They turn red, orange, and  
gold, then fall. 11. A scarecrow. 12. Raking leaves. 13. Corn. 14. Carrots.  
Accept any close or reasonable answer.





## THIS OR THAT

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# Fall Favorites: This or That

Read each pair and ask which one the person prefers or remembers best. There is no right answer. Each pair is a doorway to a story about autumn's past.

Apple pie *or* Pumpkin pie

Raking leaves *or* Watching them fall

A warm sweater *or* A cozy blanket

Hot cider *or* Hot cocoa

Crisp morning *or* Golden afternoon

A crackling fire *or* A quiet kitchen

Soup on the stove *or* Bread in the oven

A country drive *or* A walk in the leaves

Cornbread *or* Biscuits

Wool socks *or* Slippers

The first frost *or* The last warm day

A big family feast *or* A quiet supper

Pumpkins on the porch *or* Mums by the door

Football weather *or* Sweater weather

Roasted chestnuts *or* Candied apples

An early sunset *or* A harvest moon







BINGO

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# Signs of Fall Bingo

Give everyone a card. Call out or look for each sign of the season, and mark a square when you spot it or remember it. Five in a row wins, and a full card wins a round of applause. A cheerful way to welcome autumn together.

|                    |                    |                  |                    |                    |
|--------------------|--------------------|------------------|--------------------|--------------------|
| A red or gold leaf | A pumpkin          | A cozy sweater   | A cup of cider     | An acorn           |
| A scarecrow        | A rake             | A pie cooling    | A crackling fire   | Geese flying south |
| A wool blanket     | An apple           | FREE             | A harvest moon     | Corn stalks        |
| A pair of boots    | A cool morning     | A bowl of soup   | Falling leaves     | A knitted scarf    |
| A squirrel         | A jar of preserves | A cinnamon smell | A basket of apples | A frosty window    |

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## GROUP GAME

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# Name Something: Autumn Edition

Read a category and go around the group naming one thing that fits.  
Keep going until the group runs out. A gentle, cheerful way to keep minds  
active and voices in the room.

- |                                                                            |                                                                                  |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> Name something you would see on a fall walk       | <input type="checkbox"/> Name a tree that loses its leaves                       |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Name a food that tastes like autumn               | <input type="checkbox"/> Name something you would smell in a fall kitchen        |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Name something warm you would wear                | <input type="checkbox"/> Name a way to keep the house warm                       |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Name a color of a fall leaf                       | <input type="checkbox"/> Name something you would bring to a Thanksgiving dinner |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Name something you would find at a harvest table  | <input type="checkbox"/> Name a game to play indoors on a cold day               |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Name a chore to do before winter comes            | <input type="checkbox"/> Name something you would gather in the fall             |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Name something that grows on a farm               | <input type="checkbox"/> Name a type of squash or gourd                          |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Name a kind of pie                                | <input type="checkbox"/> Name something cozy for a chilly night                  |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Name something you would put on the porch in fall | <input type="checkbox"/> Name a sound you would hear on an autumn evening        |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Name an animal getting ready for winter           |                                                                                  |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Name something you would drink to stay warm       |                                                                                  |





# My Favorite Fall Memories Keepsake Cards • Sheet 1 of 4

Write the person's answers on each card as they talk, or hand them the pen if they like. Keep the cards together as a small keepsake of their autumn memories to treasure and share with family.

*advice & wishes*

**My favorite thing about autumn as a child**

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**TOLD BY:** .....

*advice & wishes*

**The house or town I grew up in, come fall**

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**TOLD BY:** .....

*advice & wishes*

**A harvest or garden I helped bring in**

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**TOLD BY:** .....

*advice & wishes*

**The warm clothes I remember wearing**

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**TOLD BY:** .....





# My Favorite Fall Memories Keepsake Cards • Sheet 2 of 4

Write the person's answers on each card as they talk, or hand them the pen if they like. Keep the cards together as a small keepsake of their autumn memories to treasure and share with family.

*advice & wishes*

**A fall meal or pie I will never forget**

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TOLD BY: \_\_\_\_\_

*advice & wishes*

**The kitchen where the family gathered**

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TOLD BY: \_\_\_\_\_

*advice & wishes*

**A Thanksgiving that stays in my heart**

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TOLD BY: \_\_\_\_\_

*advice & wishes*

**The people I spent the season with**

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TOLD BY: \_\_\_\_\_





# My Favorite Fall Memories Keepsake Cards • Sheet 3 of 4

Write the person's answers on each card as they talk, or hand them the pen if they like. Keep the cards together as a small keepsake of their autumn memories to treasure and share with family.

*advice & wishes*

**A chore I did before the cold came**

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TOLD BY: .....

*advice & wishes*

**A fall fair, festival, or gathering I loved**

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TOLD BY: .....

*advice & wishes*

**The sights and sounds of autumn where I lived**

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TOLD BY: .....

*advice & wishes*

**Something the cooler months taught me**

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TOLD BY: .....





# My Favorite Fall Memories Keepsake Cards • Sheet 4 of 4

Write the person's answers on each card as they talk, or hand them the pen if they like. Keep the cards together as a small keepsake of their autumn memories to treasure and share with family.

*advice & wishes*

**A comfort I always looked forward to**

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TOLD BY: \_\_\_\_\_

*advice & wishes*

**A tradition our family kept each fall**

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TOLD BY: \_\_\_\_\_

*advice & wishes*

**A perfect autumn day, from morning to night**

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TOLD BY: \_\_\_\_\_

*advice & wishes*

**A wish I have for my family this season**

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TOLD BY: \_\_\_\_\_

